# 4

Knowing about

# TABLE MANNERS

# WARM UP

Table manners are the rules of etiquette used while eating, which may also include the use of utensils. Different cultures observe different rules for table manners. Each family or group sets its own standards for how strictly these rules are to be followed.

**A** Scan the QR code to watch the video clip and answer the questions.

**1. What do table manners say about a person?**

_____

_____

**2. What should you do before sitting at the table?**

_____

_____

**3. What do you do after sitting down at the table?**

_____

_____

**4. What are desirable postures while sitting?**

_____

_____

**5. What are "b" and "d" mentioned?**

_____

_____

**6. When should you start eating?**

_____

_____

**7. What should you do if you need to leave the table for a while?**

_____

_____

# VOCABULARY

| Nouns | | Verbs | Adverbs | Adjectives |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| atmosphere | hygiene | appreciate | excessively | delicious |
| bite | meal | chew | fully | enjoyable |
| chopsticks | mealtime | connect | politely | experienced |
| conversation | opportunity | contribute | quickly | full |
| culture | plate | demonstrate | quietly | harmonious |
| digestion | posture | extend | simply | messy |
| habits | practice | include | slowly | particular |
| experience | respect | place | straight | pleasant |
| particles | rules | prevent | truly | positive |
| germ | manner | protect | usually | simple |
| gesture | taste | savor | | supported |
| guest | texture | share | | unsure |
| hospitality | utensils | | | wonderful |

## Exercise 1

**Instructions:** Fill in each blank with the most appropriate word.

**Nouns:** **chopsticks** **digestion** **guest** **respect** **taste**

1. I like the _____ of the food of this restaurant. I will go there again soon.
2. I need to clean my house because an important _____ will visit me today.
3. Drinking yogurt can help with your _____.
4. Chinese people use _____ to eat their food.

**Adjectives:** **enjoyable** **full** **messy** **simple** **unsure**

1. Her hair is _____ because she has just washed it but hasn't combed it.
2. I cannot eat any more food because I am already _____.
3. If you are _____ about it, just ask someone who knows.
4. Walking in the park is _____. You can see green leaves and hear singing birds.

**Verbs:** **connect** **demonstrate** **place** **prevent** **share**

1. You need to _____ the box on the shelf to clear the floor.
2. You can _____ your dancing skill by competing in a dancing contest.
3. Sunscreen lotion helps _____ our skin from sunburn.
4. Before browsing the web, you need to _____ to the internet.

**Adverbs:** **fully** **quietly** **simply** **slowly** **usually**

1. Thai people _____ eat with a spoon and a fork.
2. A man stands _____ while waiting for the elevator.
3. He _____ understands how hard it is to be good at English.
4. To start the machine, _____ press a “Start” button.

# GRAMMAR

## A Prepositions

A preposition is a word or group of words used before a noun, pronoun, or noun phrase to show direction, time, place, location, spatial relationships, or to introduce an object. Some examples of prepositions are words like "***in***," "***on***," "***at***," "***of***," and "***to***." These connectors customarily tie a noun to an idea. As in the sentence, "I went ***to*** the store.", "***to***" connects the location of "store" to where the person went.

Often a preposition is a short word. However, it can also be a longer word, multiple words, or a short phrase such as "***in front of***" in a sentence "She parked her bike ***in front of*** the school."

Prepositions can be divided into several types. In this unit, the focus will be on two types: Prepositions of Place and Prepositions of Spatial Relationship.

**1. Preposition of Place** – used to indicate the place or position of something.

1.1. To refer to a place, use the prepositions "**in**" (the point itself), "**at**" (the general vicinity), "**on**" (the surface), and "**inside**" (something contained).

**For example**: They will meet **in** the lunchroom.
She was waiting **at** the corner.
He left his phone **on** the bed.
Place the pen **inside** the drawer.

1.2. To refer to an object higher than a point, use the prepositions "**over**" and "**above**."

**For example:** The bird flew **over** the house.
The plates were on the shelf **above** the cups.

1.3. To refer to an object lower than a point, use "**below**," "**beneath**," "**under**," and "**underneath**."

**For example:** Basements are dug **below** ground.
There is hard wood **beneath** the carpet.
The squirrel hid the nuts **under** a pile of leaves.
The cat is hiding **underneath** the box.

1.4. To refer to an object close to a point, use the prepositions "**by**," "**near**," "**next to**," "**between**," "**among**," and "**opposite**."

**For example:** The gas station is **by** the grocery store.
The park is **near** her house.
Park your bike **next to** the garage.
There is a deer **between** the two trees.
There is a purple flower **among** the weeds.
The garage is **opposite** the house.

**Exercise 1**

**Instructions:** Fill in each blank with the correct Preposition of Place.

1. I love to spend time _____ home on weekends.
2. I put my favorite book _____ the coffee table.
3. I keep my accessories _____ this box.
4. When my friend arrived, I let him _____ the house.
5. I live in room 101. She lives in room 202. She lives one floor _____ me.
6. My grandmother hides her money _____ her pillow.
7. My house is _____ the market. I just cross the street to buy something.
8. Her office is _____ the coffee shop. She can walk there to buy a coffee.

**2. Prepositions of Spatial Relationship** – used to indicate an object's movement away from the source and towards a source. To refer to a spatial relationship, use the prepositions:

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| above | across | against | ahead of | along | among | around | behind |
| below | beneath | beside | between | from | in front of | inside | near |
| off | opposite | out of | through | toward | under | within | |

**For example:** The post office is **across** the street from the grocery store.
Nina sat leaning **against** the wall.
The man is walking **ahead** of us.
We will stop at many attractions **along** the way.
We walked **among** the trees in the forest.
We spent the evening walking **around** the lake.
The kids are hiding **behind** the tree.
Shaun sat **beside** the stairs.
Washing our hands can protect us **from** germs.
My shoes are **off** when I am at home.
The circus was stationed **opposite** the children's park.
A mouse got away **through** a hole in the wall.
Walk **toward** the garage and then turn left.
Place a check mark **within** the box.

**Exercise 2**

**Instructions:** Fill in each blank with the correct Preposition of Spatial Relationship.

1. When he is at home, his coat is _____.
2. Just draw a line _____ the map from point A to point B.
3. He leaned his bike _____ the tree.
4. He ran _____ his girlfriend and gave her a hug.
5. A thief got away _____ the window when the police arrived.
6. Draw a circle _____ the correct answer.
7. It's 5.00 PM. He just came home _____ work.
8. We often stand _____ the crowd at the concert.

## B Gerunds

Gerunds are words that are formed with verbs but act as nouns. They're very easy to spot, since every gerund is a **verb** with **ing** tacked to its tail. The problem here is that present participles also end with the **ing**. Besides being able to spot gerunds, you should be able to tell the difference between a gerund and a present participle. Present participles do not act as nouns. Instead, they act as modifiers or complete progressive verbs. To find gerunds in sentences, just look for a **verb + ing** that is **used as a noun**.

The following are examples of gerunds: notice the verbs they contain, and notice that every single one of them ends in **ing**.

> **Swimming** in the ocean has been Sharon's passion since she was five years old.
>
> The ballerina taught us **dancing**.
>
> **Apologizing** to me isn't enough this time.
>
> She is afraid of **flying**.
>
> They are capable of **doing** hard work.

### Exercise 3

**Instructions:** Write G on the line if a sentence contains a Gerund or write P if it contains a Present Participle.

1. While **enjoying** your meal, remember to chew quietly. _____
2. Avoid **talking** with your mouth full. _____
3. A chef is **cooking** in the kitchen. _____
4. Ask someone to pass things instead of **reaching** across the table. _____
5. That man at the back table is **talking** very loudly. _____
6. **Eating** slowly allows you to appreciate the taste and texture of the food. _____
7. Avoid **placing** your phone on the table during meals. _____
8. **Following** these rules will make mealtimes a positive experience. _____

# READING

**Instructions**: Read the following passage then answer the questions.

**P1** **Mealtime**s are a **wonderful opportunity** to **connect** with loved ones and **share** stories with friends. But to make them **truly enjoyable** for everyone, good table **manners** are key! These **simple rules** show **respect** for others, create a **pleasant atmosphere**, and allow you to **fully appreciate** the food.

**P2** Before you take a seat, wash your hands. This is a basic **hygiene practice** that **protect**s everyone from **germs**. Once seated, sit up straight with your back **supported** by the chair and your elbows off the table. This shows good **posture** and helps with **digestion**. When it comes to **utensils**, they **usually include** a fork and a knife. Most **cultures** hold the fork in the left hand and the knife in the right. When not in use, **place** them together on the **plate** at the top right. There might be other utensils like a spoon or **chopsticks**. If you're **unsure** which one to use for a **particular** dish, **simply** ask your host or a more **experienced guest politely**!

**P3** While enjoying your **meal**, remember to **chew quietly** with your mouth closed and avoid talking with your mouth full. Talking while your mouth is full can be **messy** and make it difficult for others to understand you. This shows respect for others and **prevent**s food **particles** from spraying. Take your time and **savor** each **bite**. Eating **slowly** allows you to appreciate the **taste** and **texture** of the food better and prevents you from feeling **full** too **quickly**. It also leaves time for pleasant **conversation** between bites. Additionally, avoid placing your phone on the table during meals.

**P4** Finally, good manners extend beyond eating **habits**. Use "please" and "thank you" throughout the meal. Thank the hosts for their **hospitality** and the cook for the **delicious** food. If you need something passed, politely ask someone to pass it instead of reaching across the table. Avoid making loud noises or talking **excessively**. These small **gestures demonstrate** respect and **contribute** to a **harmonious** dining experience. Following these small but important rules will make mealtimes a **positive** experience and help create a pleasant and enjoyable atmosphere for everyone at the table.

**1. What is the benefit of mealtimes apart from having food?**

a) A chance for showing your wonderful opportunity
b) A chance for connecting and sharing stories
c) A time for everyone to enjoy stories
d) A time for a pleasant atmosphere

**2. Which is NOT one of the rules for good table manners?**

a) Create a pleasant atmosphere
b) Share stories with friends
c) Show respect for others
d) Appreciate the food

**3. What is the thing to do before sitting at the table?**

a) Wash your hands
b) Protect everyone from germs
c) Sit up straight
d) Keep your elbows off the table

**4. What should you do with a fork and a knife when not using them?**

a) Put them on the table
b) put them back on their place
c) Put them on the top right of the plate
d) Put them with a spoon and chopsticks

**5. What is NOT the reason why you should avoid talking with your mouth full?**

a) It can be messy.
b) It may cause the spray on the table.
c) It shows respect for others at the table.
d) It makes it difficult to understand what you say.

**6. What should you avoid doing at the table?**

a) Saying “please” and “thank you”.
b) Taking your time and savoring each bite.
c) Placing your phone on the table during meals.
d) Asking someone politely to pass things you need.

# CONVERSATION

**Instructions**: Listen to the dialog, make understanding and answer the questions.

**Tony**: Mom, Sarah invited me to a dinner party at her house next week!

**Mom**: **That's wonderful!** That's great. You must be so excited.

**Tony**: Kind of. **But what if I mess up on the table?** But what if I do something embarrassing?

**Mom**: Hold on. **Don't be afraid.** Don't worry too much. Most likely, it'll be just like dinner at home, with regular utensils.

**Tony**: What if I have to use a napkin the right way or something?

**Mom**: A napkin is just a fancy way of saying a cloth to keep your clothes clean. You put it on your lap and use it to wipe your mouth after you take a bite.

**Tony**: **Oh, that's it?** Oh, is it that simple?

**Mom**: Pretty much! As for utensils, the fork goes in your left hand and the knife in your right. You use the knife to cut your food and the fork to eat it. Simple, right?

**Tony**: **I guess.** I think so.

**Mom**: Look, sweetie, everyone makes mistakes sometimes. Even grown-ups! The most important thing is to be polite and ask if you're unsure. Sarah's family will be happy to help you if you need anything.

**Tony**: Do you think so?

**Mom**: Absolutely. Dinner parties are a great way to spend time with friends and family. It's more about having fun and enjoying good company than using the perfect fork.

**Tony**: Okay, that makes me feel better. Thanks, Mom!

**1. Why does Tony feel worried about going to a dinner party at Sarah's house?**

a) He doesn't know Sarah well.
b) He doesn't know how to go there.
c) He doesn't know table manners well.
d) He doesn't know what to bring along.

**2. Which is NOT mentioned about a napkin?**

a) It is a cloth used to protect your clothes.
b) It is to be put on your lap while dining.
c) You can use it to wipe your mouth.
d) You can put it on the table while dining.

**3. According to Mom, what is the most important thing at the dining table?**

a) To be polite
b) To ask if unsure about what to do
c) To be happy to help
d) To make you feel better

**4. What is NOT the benefit of dinner parties?**

a) Spending time with friends and family
b) Having fun and enjoying good company
c) Practicing table manners for children
d) Having to help others at the table

**5. How does Tony feel after talking with his mom?**

a) Wonderful
b) Excited
c) Afraid
d) Better

## Exercise 1

**Instructions**: Create a simple dialog about table manners in your country or your community. You can use any form of technology for your writing (5 marks). Rehearse with your partner / friend then record it into a file for another 5-marks presentation. Your conversation should not exceed five sentences each.

**Example:**

**ANAN**: Hey Tawan, I'm going to my aunt's place for Songkran.
Anything I should remember about Thai table manners?
**TAWAN**: Good question! Your aunt might appreciate you brushing up on them.
**ANAN**: Yeah, I don't want to make any mistakes. What are some key things to keep in mind?
**TAWAN**: Sure! First, wait for the elders to sit down before you do.
**ANAN**: Got it, respect for the elders. What about serving myself food?
**TAWAN**: Always wait until everyone is served before you start eating.
Small portions are a good idea too.
**ANAN**: Okay, small portions first. Is there anything specific about utensils?
**TAWAN**: We mostly use a spoon and fork in Thailand. The spoon is for everything, and the fork pushes food onto it. Knives aren't common.
**ANAN**: Great, spoon and fork it is. Thanks so much, Tawan! I feel more confident now.
**TAWAN**: Good on you. Have fun.

## Your Writing Task

Fill in each blank in the conversation with the most appropriate information given below.

A. you also can eat it with folk and spoon
B. wait until everyone is ready
C. wait for the elders to sit down before you do
D. Isaan dining manners
E. may just do what they do and follow them

**A**: Hey ___B___, I'm going to a traditional Isaan wedding party in Ubon.
Anything I should know about _____**(1)**_____?
**B**: Good question! Your host might appreciate you preparing for that.
**A**: Yeah, I don't want to do something embarrassing. What are things to do?
**B**: Sure! First, _____**(2)**_____.
**A**: Got it, respect for the elders. What about serving myself food?
**B**: Always _____**(3)**_____ before you start eating.
**A**: Okay, wait first. What if I have to eat sticky rice?
**B**: People mostly eat sticky rice with their hands. But _____**(4)**_____.
Don't forget to use serving spoons for the shared dishes.
**A**: Okay, I may try both. Thanks so much, ___B___! I feel more confident now.
**B**: Isaan people are friendly and kind. You _____**(5)**_____.
**A**: Thank you so much ___B___ for your information.
**B**: No problems. Enjoy your party.

You may create your own conversation similar to the example above.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

## Thai Table Manners

**1. Wai**

- Embrace the Thai greeting tradition of the wai, which involves pressing your palms together at chest level and bowing your head slightly. Use this gesture to greet hosts and elders.
- Return a wai with one of equal or slightly lower status when receiving it.

**2. Utensil Etiquette:**

- While chopsticks are an option, discover the Thai preference for using a fork and spoon. Hold the fork in your left hand and the spoon in your right.
- Employ the fork to guide food onto the spoon for consumption, avoiding direct mouth-to-fork contact.

**3. Sharing Dishes:**

- Experience the communal nature of Thai meals, with shared dishes placed at the center of the table. Use serving spoons or provided utensils to transfer food onto your plate, respecting communal dining etiquette.
- Take moderate portions from shared dishes, ensuring everyone has an opportunity to enjoy the meal.

**4. Showing Respect to the Host:**

- Begin eating after the host or the most senior person at the table has started their meal.
- Express gratitude and enjoyment of the food, complimenting the host as a gesture of appreciation.